

Japan Daily Brief

Tuesday, September 22, 2026

2,344 words · 9 min read

RE: Takaichi-Trump bilateral at UNGA · Typhoon Dujuan kills 6 · DPRK hypersonic launch · BOJ rate-hike pace · US-Japan-ROK trilateral

NIKKEI 225
65,018.95
▲ +2.40%

USD/JPY
157.05
▲ +1.15%

BRENT
\$97.61
▼ -6.88%

BOJ RATE
1.25%

• TODAY AT A GLANCE

- 1 Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** met President Donald Trump in New York on Tuesday, stressing Japanese investment in the US and seeking alignment on China two days before Trump's scheduled summit with Xi Jinping.
- 2 Typhoon Dujuan killed at least six people and left six missing across eastern Japan, triggering landslides and flooding in Chiba and Kanagawa, with the SDF deployed for disaster relief.
- 3 North Korea test-fired two ballistic missiles toward the Sea of Japan and touted what Kim Jong Un called a 'new-type weapon' — assessed by experts as a hypersonic system — prompting trilateral US-Japan-ROK consultations in New York.

• TOP STORIES

ALLIANCE

Takaichi meets Trump in New York, seeking China alignment before Xi summit

Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** held talks with President **Donald Trump** in New York on Tuesday, aiming to align views on China's economic and security pressure and to highlight Japanese investment in the US — with Trump's summit with Xi Jinping scheduled for Thursday. The bilateral was arranged two days before the US-China summit, reflecting Tokyo's concern about a potential US-China deal that could disadvantage Japan.

per NYT: "Japan Meets With Trump, Hoping to Get His Help on China"

NYT

ENERGY

Typhoon Dujuan kills 6, leaves 6 missing across eastern Japan; SDF deployed

The death toll from Typhoon Dujuan rose to six on Tuesday with six others still missing after landslides and flooding struck Chiba, Kanagawa and surrounding prefectures; *more than 74,000* people remained under evacuation orders in the Tokyo region. The SDF was dispatched for disaster relief operations in Chiba and Kanagawa.

per Mainichi: "Death toll climbs to 6 after typhoon brings heavy rain to Japan"

MAINICHI

DPRK

North Korea fires two ballistic missiles, touts new hypersonic weapon system

North Korea fired two ballistic missiles toward the Sea of Japan — with one traveling approximately 600 km — and subsequently announced a successful test of what **Kim Jong Un** called a 'new-type weapon' described by experts as a hypersonic missile system designed to give enemies an 'incurable headache.' The US, Japan and South Korea held trilateral consultations in New York in response, reaffirming denuclearization goals and calling for dialogue.

REUTERS · SEP 22 | JAPAN TIMES · SEP 22 | KYODO · SEP 22

ECONOMY-BOJ

BOJ set to maintain quarterly rate-hike pace; yen extends losing streak

The Financial Times's Monetary Policy Radar reports the Bank of Japan is set to maintain its new quarterly pace of rate rises from the current 1.25% policy rate — the highest in 31 years — while the yen extended its losing streak as traders questioned the BOJ's hike pace following a meeting viewed as disappointing by markets. UBS Asset Management's head of fixed income said the firm is ready to sell yen if Japan intervenes again.

per FT: "Bank of Japan set to maintain new quarterly pace of rate rises"

FT

• OVERNIGHT

DISASTERS

Typhoon Dujuan: record rain hits Tokyo region, 74,000 under evacuation orders · NYT

Typhoon Dujuan brought record-breaking rainfall to eastern Japan, killing at least five and triggering landslides and floods across Chiba and Kanagawa. More than 74,000 people remained under evacuation orders in the Tokyo region as of Tuesday.

ALLIANCE

Takaichi scrambles to reach Trump before Xi summit — Asia Times · Asia Times

Asia Times analyzes Takaichi's push to secure a Trump bilateral ahead of the US-China summit, framing the timing as Japan's effort to shape the Washington-Beijing agenda before the two leaders meet. The article highlights Tokyo's anxiety about a potential US-China deal on trade or technology that could affect Japan.

ECONOMY-BOJ

UBS AM's Zhao ready to sell yen if BOJ intervention resumes · Bloomberg

Bloomberg reports that UBS Asset Management's fixed-income head is positioned to sell yen if Japanese authorities intervene in currency markets again, citing the yen's continued weakness at 157 per dollar post-BOJ meeting. Markets characterized the BOJ's latest meeting as disappointing given the muted forward guidance.

CHINA-JAPAN

China FM labels Typhon deployment further proof of Japan 'remilitarization' · China MOFA re Japan

China's Foreign Ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun, at the September 21 regular press conference, described Japan's hosting of the US Typhon intermediate-range missile system as 'another example of Japan's accelerated remilitarization' and urged Japan to halt what Beijing characterizes as a return to militarism. The spokesperson

separately declined to confirm whether US-China discussions in Washington would cover China's rare-earth export controls on Japan.

ALLIANCE

Nikkei: Japan's response to US 'foreign pressure' must benefit both sides · Nikkei Asia

A Nikkei Asia commentary argues Japan must calibrate its response to US economic and security demands to ensure mutual benefit, framing the Takaichi-Trump summit against the backdrop of tariff and investment expectations from Washington. The piece signals elite concern that Tokyo risks over-conceding under US pressure.

• STAT OF THE DAY

6

Deaths from Typhoon Dujuan in Japan (Sep 22)

Typhoon Dujuan's death toll rose to six with six more missing after landslides and flooding struck Chiba, Kanagawa and surrounding prefectures; the SDF was called up for disaster relief.

Death toll climbs to 6 after typhoon brings heavy rain to Japan — Mainichi

• JAPANESE GOVERNMENT

KANTEI/PM · CABINET · MOFA · MOD · METI · MOF · BOJ · DIET · TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 22, 2026

PM Watch: PM appeared today · 0 day(s) since last confirmed appearance — Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi arrived in New York and held a bilateral meeting with President Trump on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly, with her investment-in-the-US message as the central talking point.

外務省 · MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS · *Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi*

Motegi meets UN General Assembly President Dr. Khalilur Rahman in New York

Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi held a bilateral meeting on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly with Dr. Khalilur Rahman, President of the 81st Session of the UN General Assembly, in New York.

→ [MOFA ↗](#)

外務省 · MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS · *Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi*

Japan-Nepal Foreign Ministers' meeting held in New York

Foreign Minister Motegi held a bilateral meeting with his Nepalese counterpart on the margins of the UN General Assembly in New York.

→ [MOFA ↗](#)

統合幕僚監部 · JOINT STAFF / SDF

SDF deployed to Chiba and Kanagawa for Typhoon Dujuan disaster relief

Disaster-relief deployment orders were issued to the SDF following Typhoon Dujuan's landslides and flooding in Chiba and Kanagawa prefectures; at least five were dead and six missing at the time of the request.

DIET SESSIONS / LDP

LDP

Takaichi's pick for parliamentary affairs chief draws concern over Kantei power shift

Prime Minister Takaichi's selection of a lawmaker without cabinet experience as parliamentary affairs chief is seen by observers as strengthening the Prime Minister's Office's influence while reducing opposition input into Diet management.

LDP

Yoshimasa Hayashi seen as LDP leadership contender following Cabinet exit

Of the four candidates in the last LDP leadership race, **Yoshimasa Hayashi** — who lost the Internal Affairs minister post in the September 17 reshuffle — is now the only one holding neither a cabinet nor senior party post, positioning him as a potential future leadership challenger.

• PUBLIC SENTIMENT & APPROVAL POLLING

POLLSTER	APPROVE	DISAPPROVE
Yomiuri · Sep 19, 2026	59%	30%
FNN · Sep 15, 2026	61.6%	32.2%
NHK · Sep 10, 2026	52.8%	30.8%
JNN · Sep 7, 2026	62.5%	34.9%
Nikkei · Sep 5, 2026	62%	32%
Asahi · Sep 5, 2026	53%	33%
ANN · Sep 5, 2026	55.4%	29.9%
Kyodo · Sep 10, 2026	50.2%	33.9%

Discourse: Takaichi's selection of a cabinet-inexperienced lawmaker as parliamentary affairs chief is drawing concern about concentration of power in the Prime Minister's Office, while Yoshimasa Hayashi's exit from cabinet positions him as a potential future LDP leadership challenger.

Poll tracker: [Observing Japan approval-rating aggregator →](#)

• BUSINESS & ECONOMY

MANUFACTURING · THE JAPAN TIMES · MITSUI FUDOSAN

Mitsui Fudosan breaks ground on British Library redevelopment — largest Europe investment at ¥231 billion

Mitsui Fudosan held a groundbreaking ceremony for the British Library redevelopment in London, with a total project cost of approximately ¥231 billion — the largest single European investment by the major Japanese real estate developer.

Japan moves to secure domestic vaccine production capacity for future crises

Japan is pursuing policies to ensure domestic vaccine manufacturing capacity to reduce dependence on imports in the event of the next public health emergency, following pandemic-era supply vulnerabilities.

Japan companies deploy AI-powered robots across healthcare and manufacturing to address labor shortage

With Japan facing a severe labor shortage across healthcare and manufacturing sectors, companies are increasingly deploying AI-powered robots as a structural response, according to Kyodo reporting carried by Mainichi.

REGIONAL PRESSURE WATCH **WATCH**

High — 57 items (Japanese government: 6, adversary signal: 53; DPRK: 46, China MOFA: 7, BOJ: 6)

CHINA

China's Foreign Ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun used the September 21 press conference to label Japan's hosting of the US Typhon intermediate-range missile system 'another example of Japan's accelerated remilitarization' and called on Japan to halt what Beijing frames as a return to militarism. The spokesperson separately declined to confirm whether the forthcoming US-China Washington summit would address China's rare-earth export controls on Japan — leaving open the status of that economic-coercion lever as Takaichi meets Trump.

NORTH KOREA

North Korea fired two ballistic missiles toward the Sea of Japan — South Korea's JCS confirmed one traveled approximately 440 km from the Wonsan area — and subsequently announced a 'successful' test of a 'new-type weapon' that outside experts assess as a hypersonic missile system. Kim Jong Un described the weapon as capable of giving enemies an 'incurable headache'; US, Japan and South Korea held trilateral consultations in New York in response, with foreign ministers reaffirming denuclearization goals and calling for dialogue.

RUSSIA

No new Russian military or territorial-dispute activity toward Japan is reported in today's articles.

Senkaku / ECS: No new China Coast Guard, PLAN or MOFA incidents specifically in the Senkaku / East China Sea corridor are reported in today's articles; the sustained Chinese rhetorical campaign against Japan's defense buildup continues.

"Japan's deployment of Typhon missile system another example of Japan's accelerated remilitarization"

Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson (Guo Jiakun) · Japan's deployment of Typhon missile system another example of Japan's accelerated remilitarization: Chinese FM — Global Times

"incurable headache"

Kim Jong Un (via KCNA, translated) · North Korea reports new missile test designed to give enemy 'incurable headache' — Reuters

Bottom line: North Korea's two-missile salvo combined with the touting of a new hypersonic weapon system — timed to the US-China Washington summit — is the sharpest regional-pressure signal of the week; the simultaneous Chinese FM framing of the Typhon system as proof of Japanese remilitarization, and the

deliberate non-answer on rare-earth export controls at the Trump-Xi summit, keeps Beijing's economic-coercion lever in play as Takaichi meets Trump.

• U.S.-JAPAN RELATIONS

TRADE · NIKKEI ASIA

Takaichi to stress scale of Japanese investment in US in Trump talks

Ahead of the bilateral, Nikkei Asia reported Takaichi planned to highlight Japanese corporate investment in the United States as a central argument in negotiations — a framing consistent with the \$550 billion US-Japan strategic investment framework agreed in 2025.

ALLIANCE · REUTERS

US reaffirms commitment to Japan, Korea, Taiwan ahead of Trump-Xi summit

Secretary of State Marco Rubio met his Japanese and South Korean counterparts in New York to reaffirm US backing for both allies — and for Taiwan — delivering an explicit signal to Beijing before Trump's summit with Xi Jinping.

• INDO-PACIFIC PARTNERS

TRILATERAL · THE JAPAN TIMES

Japan, US, South Korea trilateral backs Taiwan, calls for DPRK dialogue

The foreign ministers of Japan, South Korea and the United States met in New York, backing Taiwan and reaffirming North Korea denuclearization goals while calling for dialogue.

TRILATERAL · YONHAP RE JAPAN

South Korea-US-Japan trilateral foreign ministers meeting held in New York

The top diplomats of South Korea, the United States and Japan met in New York for a trilateral session addressing North Korean denuclearization and regional security.

SOUTHEAST ASIA · NIKKEI ASIA

Japan's Mitsubishi to raise stake in Philippine conglomerate Ayala to 20%

Mitsubishi Corporation plans to increase its shareholding in Ayala Corporation to 20%, deepening Japan's strategic economic presence in the Philippines.

SOUTHEAST ASIA · THE JAPAN TIMES

Indonesia to develop earthquake early warning system with Japan's help

Indonesia plans trial runs of a Japan-assisted earthquake early warning system in Jakarta and selected regions by 2030, deepening bilateral disaster-risk cooperation.

• EXPERT ANALYSIS AND EVENTS

OP-EDS & THINK TANK COMMENTARY

CSIS JAPAN CHAIR

Behind the Headlines: What Motivates and Moves Japanese Elite Opinion on Nuclear Weapons Acquisition

Japanese elite opinion on nuclear weapons acquisition is shaped by a distinct set of motivating factors that differ from popular opinion and merit direct policy attention as the alliance's extended-deterrence credibility is stress-tested.

This CSIS Japan Chair product examines what drives and shifts elite opinion in Japan on the question of independent or allied nuclear deterrence. The analysis situates elite attitudes within Japan's evolving security debate, including the Takaichi

government's defense buildup and US-Japan extended-deterrence consultations. It offers a framework for understanding the conditions under which elite opinion could shift toward more assertive nuclear positioning.

SO WHAT As the Takaichi-Trump summit tests US extended-deterrence commitments and North Korea advances hypersonic delivery vehicles, the drivers of Japanese elite opinion on nuclear acquisition directly shape the political feasibility of alliance-dependent deterrence.

• SOCIAL STATEMENTS



Sanae Takaichi

Prime Minister of Japan · Asahi Shimbun · Sep 21

“法の支配や国連改革訴えたい”

Analyst: Prime Minister Takaichi stated her intention to press for rule-of-law and UN reform in her UNGA address, per Asahi Shimbun reporting on her departure for New York.

Source →

• THE WIRE

POLITICS-DIET

NIKKEI ASIA

Takaichi cabinet approval holds at 62% in Nikkei poll after reshuffle

A Nikkei poll found Prime Minister Takaichi's cabinet approval rating unchanged at 62% following her first cabinet reshuffle completed on September 17.

ALLIANCE

REUTERS/INTERNAZIONALE

US stresses backing for Japan, Korea and Taiwan — Internazionale

International coverage highlights the US assurance to Japan, South Korea and Taiwan delivered by US officials ahead of the Trump-Xi Washington summit.

DPRK

THE HINDU RE JAPAN

Two North Korea Asian Games members reportedly seek asylum in Japan

Two North Korean members of the Asian Games delegation in Aichi-Nagoya reportedly sought asylum in Japan, according to The Hindu and The Straits Times — a rare occurrence given the near-absence of North Korean officials on Japanese soil.

• UPCOMING

Sep
23

Trump-Xi Washington summit (scheduled)

President Trump is set to meet Chinese President Xi Jinping in Washington approximately two days after the Takaichi-Trump bilateral, a sequencing Tokyo sought to shape the US-China agenda before the summit.

Sep
24

Takaichi UNGA general debate speech

Prime Minister Takaichi is expected to deliver Japan's statement in the UN General Assembly general debate, where she has signaled she will press for rule-of-law and UN reform themes.

Oct
1

BOJ next Monetary Policy Meeting (estimated)

The Bank of Japan's next policy meeting is expected in late September or early October; FT analysis indicates the BOJ intends to maintain a quarterly rate-hike pace from the current 1.25% level.

Oct
15

Fall Diet extraordinary session (estimated)

A fall extraordinary Diet session is expected; timing has not been confirmed in today's articles but is consistent with standard Diet calendar practice.

Dec
1

Cabinet draft budget (recurring — Japan FY2027)

Japan's annual cabinet draft budget for fiscal year 2027 is expected in December; ministries have already submitted tax-break requests, including bond-purchase and wage-hike incentives.

CSIS Japan Chair

JAPAN DAILY BRIEF

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